

The Great King of Tantras Called the Glorious Blessed One Ekajaṭā's Great Kalpa Tantra

Śrī Bhagavatī Ekajaṭā Mahākalpa Tantra Rāja Nāma · Toh 476 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་བཅའ་ལྷན་འདས་རལ་པ་གཙག་པའ་བེད་གླ་པའ་རིཙ་ཀའི་ལྷ་པ་ཆེན་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ

Toh 476 in the Kangyur is a tantric text known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Bhagavatī Ekajaṭā Mahākalpa Tantra Rāja and in Tibetan as the Dpal bcom ldan 'das ral pa gcig pa'i brtag pa'i rgyud kyi rgyal po chen po, rendered in English as The Great King of Tantras Called the Glorious Blessed One Ekajaṭā's Tantra. It belongs to the tantric section of the Kangyur and is devoted to the fierce protective deity Ekajaṭā, a prominent figure in the Vajrayāna tradition associated with the safeguarding of the Dharma and wrathful enlightened activity. The text opens in classical sūtra style, with the Buddha residing at the summit of Vajra Mountain at Caṇḍālā in the company of an assembly of great bodhisattvas accomplished in the profoundly secret teachings, suggesting a scripture that expounds ritual, maṇḍala, and tantric practice centered on Ekajaṭā. As a Mahākalpa tantra — a "great tantra of ritual procedures" — it provides an extensive doctrinal and ceremonial framework within the broader corpus of Vajrayāna canonical literature preserved in the Kangyur.

In the language of India: Śrī Bhagavatī Ekajaṭā Mahākalpa Tantra Rāja Nāma.
In the Tibetan language: The Great King of Tantras Called the Glorious Blessed One Ekajaṭā's Tantra.

Homage to the Blessed One Ekajaṭā.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling at the summit of Vajra Mountain at Caṇḍālā, together with the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, the King of Terrors, the Lord of Nāgas, the One with the Faces of the Sun and Moon, the Mudrā of Arrayed Wisdom, and other bodhisattvas, great beings who had attained mastery over the treasury of the profoundly secret suchness of the secret, who were perfectly certain in the maṇḍalas of all the Tathāgatas, who abided in the manner of an ocean of lineages, assemblies, samaya-commitments, and great vows with their mudrās, who sported in the great bliss that is more secret than the secret, who possessed the primordial wisdom arising definitively from the unsurpassable union of skillful means and wisdom, and who were possessed of immeasurable skill in overcoming the arising and the latent tendencies of all beings.

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi rose from his seat, placed his right knee on the ground, joined his palms together, and addressed the Blessed One in these words:

O sovereign of the vajra, the great vajra,
King of vajras, lord of all,
Father who generates all buddhas —
Speak to me of the great bliss wheel.

You who dispel the dense obscuration of the three realms of existence,
Who do not abide in nirvāṇa,
Who protect all embodied beings with great love —
O guide, I beseech you, show us the path.

Through what method, when one having stable intelligence and compassion
Practices it openly,
Does the mudrā of the five bodies become accomplished?
That supreme matter — please, teach it here.

Arising greatly in the vajra maṇḍala,
As taught in the great tantra of one hundred thousand verses —
The one with a single braid who is the chief of the garland maṇḍala —
What is kept hidden? Speak it out of love.

When this petition was made, the Blessed One, the lord of the entire vajra maṇḍala, exceedingly delighted, smiled, and from the gateway of his mouth sent forth rays of light in the five colors. These illuminated all the world-systems and then gathered back, thoroughly purifying the assembled maṇḍala of the retinue. They then circled the Blessed One himself three times and dissolved into the crown of his head.

Next, from the jewel of the uṣṇīṣa at the crown of his head there arose rays of white light like jasmine and like moonlight, and the arrangement of the manifest arising of the great maṇḍala appeared above his head, made clearly visible to direct perception.

The Blessed One then spoke these words to the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi: "You of great compassion — for the sake of the healing and happiness of all sentient beings, you have asked well, truly well, about the supreme secret of Ekajaṭā, the great vajra elegance, the treasury of the manifest arising of the maṇḍalas of all the Tathāgatas. This Vajradhāra moment is yours, and this is what will illuminate you. I too recall that formerly,

here at this very summit of Vajra Mountain, when I had become the bodhisattva named Joyful in Stars, I sported together with all the Tathāgatas and with the secret of Jñāna Ekajaṭā, and ripened immeasurable sentient beings. Therefore, with great compassion and skill in means, listen well and take to heart this tantra of definitive emergence from secret mantra, for I shall explain it to you."

The bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi listened as the Blessed One had directed, and the Blessed One then declared:

Oṃ āḥ oṃ oṃ āḥ hrīm trīm hūṃ.

Oṃ āḥ sarva-tathāgata-garbha vajra-tattva sarva-jñāna-jvāla hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ sarva-tathāgata-maitrī vajra-tattvopāya sarva hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-jñāna hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ āḥ vajra-cakra a hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-ratna i hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-padma u hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-viśva e hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-moha aṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-varṇa ī hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-rāga ū hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-dveṣa ai hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-sthira au hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-yoga aṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-jvāla āḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-bala āḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-rūpaṇī ka hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-śabda ca hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-gandha ṭa hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ rasa-ta vajra hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-sparśa pa hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-dharma ya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-kṣetra śa hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-ālokākṣaḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-oṃkuśa rī hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-pāśa rī hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-bandha lī hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. Oṃ āḥ vajra-ghaṇṭa lī hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

Oṃ svabhāva-śuddhāḥ sarva-dharmāḥ svabhāva-śuddho 'ham. Oṃ vajra-śuddhāḥ sarva-dharmāḥ vajra-śuddho 'ham. Oṃ yoga-śuddhāḥ sarva-dharmāḥ yoga-śuddho 'ham.

Vajra Akṣobhya of the single topknot —
Akṣobhya together with the bodhisattvas,
Vajra Lamp, the vajra itself,
and Vajra Lasso: meditate on these fully.

Delusion with its habitual tendencies, attachment,
and aversion abide in the vajra wheel.
From Mount Meru, sun, moon, and the banner,
the vajra of the four elements arises likewise.

In the four courtyards: mirror, lute,
and what arises from supreme fragrance and food —
the vajra goddesses of form, sound, scent, taste —
let the wise ever hold these in meditative equipoise.

Beyond direction: the outer garment, the Dharma-source,
the maṇḍala, what arises from the butter-lamp —
through the realms of touch, domain, and luminosity,
behold the vajra goddesses.

At the four gates: hook, lasso,
chain, and bell, fully transformed —
meditate on Vajra Hook and the rest.
With their own mark, supremely beautiful as skull-cups,
Fierce, wrathful, with tangled matted hair,
blazing and crackling with roaring fire pervading all,
awesome with skeletons rising in the east and other directions —
dwelling in their glory, turning leftward.

Laughing ha-ha with sovereign power,
a golden, luminous, glorious forest.
In unbearable darkness, beyond truth,
crying kili-kili in the wind.

The peerless one is fourfold in her corners.
Mindfulness and the sense faculties are the four doors.
The four meditative concentrations are the four descending stairways.
The eight liberations are the eight pillars.

For the sake of the seven branches of awakening,
there is the lattice and the half-lattice.
In the four directions are the four immeasurables.
The lotus wheel: wisdom and skillful means.

The eight consciousnesses, perfectly purified —
these are the eight great charnel grounds.
Moon, mirror, sun: equanimity.
Seed, mark, and conceptual elaboration,
the transformation and the accomplishment of activity —
the fully perfected dharmadhātu is primordial wisdom.
The five aggregates and the four defilements likewise,

the four great elements and the eight sense domains,

the four kinds of feeling: the goddess of pure arising,

the wheel whose very nature is primordial wisdom.

Laughter, meeting, embrace, and union —

worship: o a gora dema,

ka o tri ko ka la kā hi,

pre gṛ sau su na si ma ku,

ha hi hu he ho haṃ,

a i u e o aṃ.

Ripening in manifold aspects,

utterly vanquishing and free from all marks —

joy, supreme joy, freedom from joy,

and co-emergent joy: these are the defining characteristics.

Laughter, meeting, embrace, and union —

for the sake of great bliss: the vase,

the secret, wisdom, and great bliss.

One attains the kingship of the four empowerments. Jaḥ Hūṃ Baṃ Hoḥ.

Wearied by meditation on an object, one desires habituation to something else:

cultivate suchness, free from all conceptuality.

The yoga of dream and sky

is to be placed perfectly, day and night, without ceasing.

At the crown, at the heart, and at the navel,

upon the moon, the lotus, and the sun,

the syllables Hṃ, Hūṃ, and A —

the continuum of bliss, clarity, and non-conceptuality.

The vital essence: transference, absorption, and dwelling;

transformation, motion, and leaping;

shooting the arrow, gathering, going and coming — all joined together.

The bodiless mind goes wherever it will;

once dissolved, it radiates and blazes forth.

Cultivate mastery and the union of lips;

through aspiration, accomplish and transform the seed.

By projection and recollection, the purpose of the intermediate state is

accomplished —
and likewise in this very life.

Through the junction of consciousness at death and the junction of states of existence as well,
the king of yogins, possessed of skillful means,
easily traverses the three grounds of great bliss.

Śaṃsāra and nirvāṇa, the definite and the indefinite,
arising through dependent origination and its reversal, and cessation;
pacification, enrichment, magnetism, and pacification and the rest —
in all this, have no doubt.

The unceasing continuum of union,
and luminosity, co-emergent and all-pervading —
like a bee extracting nectar from a flower,
in every way one accomplishes the aim.

Oṃ a kā ro mu khaṃ sarva dharmā nāṃ ādya nutpanna tvā ta sarva ni sva
bhā va hūṃ.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, all those in the assembly —
the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi and the rest — were filled with great joy, and
with these verses praised him and worshipped him, striving in offerings of
inconceivable and immeasurable kinds:

O Blessed One, protector of the world, excellent!
In order to protect wandering beings from affliction,
you set aside the meditative absorption of emptiness
and, out of great loving-kindness, manifested in form — well done!

O Blessed One of great compassion, excellent!
In order to liberate sentient beings from suffering,
not abiding at the extreme of peace,
you displayed manifold emanations of great love — well done!

O Blessed One, king of great bliss, excellent!
In order to accomplish the benefit of bliss for embodied beings,
your mind unwavering in the undefiled expanse,
you radiantly manifested great joy everywhere — well done!

O sovereign Vajra King, excellent!
In order to refresh those beings who are weary,
never dwelling in a single extreme or broken continuity,

you accomplish without exception all that is sought — wondrous!

Thereupon, the greater part of that retinue and all those great bodhisattvas of the vajra family, confirmed in what the Blessed One had declared, while abiding in a meditative absorption of skillful means and wisdom that is inconceivable and immeasurable, displayed many great miraculous manifestations through the blessings of all, for the benefit of all sentient beings.

The Blessed One then declared: Whosoever shall hear, retain, uphold, and so forth this great secret tantra, the king of tantras, known as the Blessed One Vajra Akṣobhya — they shall be regarded with care by me and by all the Victors. The many billions and trillions of deities in the maṇḍala of the king Blazing Vajra, the blood-drinker, shall follow in their wake. By mere recollection, they shall be made the personal deity throughout all their lives. No harm whatsoever from humans or non-humans or the like, no injury, no fright, and no ill omen whatsoever shall arise. The very dwelling in which they reside shall become a sacred shrine. They shall become an inexhaustible treasury of all vidyās and attainments.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, those bodhisattvas, and the gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas — the whole world — rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

The great unsurpassed Vajra Tantra, the examination of Ekajāṭā, the Blessed One — is complete.

The great lord of yoga, Śrī Jagatamitra.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase translated as "the summit of Vajra Mountain at Caṇḍālā" renders the Tibetan *lcangs lo can gyi gnas rdo rje'i ri bo'i zom*. The first element, *lcangs lo can*, literally means "the place of Caṇḍālā" or "the place of the one with iron leaves," which is sometimes identified as a cremation ground or a specific sacred site; the translation renders it by its locative sense without forcing an identification.

The term rendered "the King of Terrors" for *'jigs byed rgyal po* is the deity Yamāntaka, "the king who terrifies," a standard wrathful form associated with Mañjuśrī, here appearing as a member of the retinue without further elaboration in the text.

The "five bodies" in the verse renders *sku Inga*, referring to the five buddha-bodies (*pañcakāya*), an expanded body-doctrine beyond the standard three-body (*trikāya*) schema, standard in tantric contexts.

The epithet "Ekajāṭā" (Tibetan: ral pa gcig pa, "the one-braided one") is preserved in Sanskrit throughout as the name of the deity whose tantra this is.

- The passage consists of two distinct sections. The first is a long sequence of tantric mantras and dhāraṇī syllables, transliterated directly from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit. These are preserved verbatim as is standard for mantra material, which is not translated but only faithfully transcribed. Minor phonetic irregularities in the Tibetan transliteration have been normalized toward recognizable Sanskrit forms where the intent is unambiguous.

The verse section that follows is dense tantric maṇḍala description, correlating structural features of the maṇḍala palace with categories of Buddhist doctrine: the five aggregates, eight consciousnesses, four immeasurables, seven branches of awakening, four meditative concentrations, eight liberations, four great elements, and so on. The four joys listed at the close are the standard fourfold schema of tantric bliss-gnosis: joy, supreme joy, joy of cessation, and co-emergent joy. The syllable strings near the end (pūjā o a gora dema, etc.) appear to be either seed syllables or a phonetically rendered mantra passage embedded within the verse; they are preserved as found without further interpretation, as their exact reconstruction is uncertain.

The term rendered "Dharma-source" for chos-'byung (dharmodaya, the triangular source of all phenomena) is standard in Yoganiruttara tantric contexts.

- The mantra "Om a kā ro mukhaṃ sarva dharmāṇāṃ ādyanutpannatvāt sarva nisvabhāva hūṃ" is a well-known Vajrayāna dhāraṇī formula asserting that the syllable A is the gateway to all phenomena because from the beginning they are unborn and devoid of intrinsic nature. It is rendered in transliterated Sanskrit as it appears in the Tibetan and is not translated, consistent with treatment of mantra throughout.

The title "Ekajāṭā" renders "ral pa gcig pa," meaning "she of the single braid," a fierce tantric deity. The full title may also be rendered "The Great Unsurpassed Vajra Tantra: The Tantra Examining Ekajāṭā," and this closing colophon identifies the text.

The phrase rendered "the three grounds of great bliss" translates "bde chen sa gsum," which in tantric context refers to three levels or stages of great bliss, though the precise enumeration varies by commentarial tradition.

- This appears to be a title or colophon attribution naming the author or translator as Śrī Jagatamitra, "the noble friend of the world," a Sanskrit epithet rendered directly into Tibetan phonetic transcription. No significant doctrinal uncertainty arises here.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly

proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.
May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.